the importance of the senses and developing motor abilities. Still some other preschools may concentrate on cognitive growth in one or many ways. But many preschools claim that they have goals in all these areas.

The types of preschool included are,

(i) Day care

(ii) Montessori school

(iii) Kindergarten

(iv) Nursery school

(v) Balwadi

(vi) Anganwadi

(vii) Laboratory nursery school

ACTIVITY I

- Visit a nearby preschool and observe the children.
- Write a report on it.

(i). Day care

Day care means day time care for preschoolers who are dependent. This is provided in the absence of child's parent. Parents are employed and are not available to cater to the needs of their preschoolers.

Day care refers to the *care provided for toddlers, preschoolers and school-aged children,* either in their own homes, in the home of a relative or other care givers, or in a center-based facility. Center based care is also called child care centers or day care centers.These facilitate care for groups of children. Many parents prefer center-based care because they want their *children to be safe* and have a *better learning environment.*



Day care center have trained staff and their work is supervised. Care is still available even when a staff member is absent/ on leave. More resources and equipment are available. In day care center, children's *cognitive development* is enhanced. This may be because of day care children have opportunities to interact with other children and are exposed to more learning materials.

The only drawback of day care center is that is quite costly and permanency of staff is doubtful.

Family child care providers

Family child care providers offer care for children in the provider's home. This is also a part of day care for children. Parents often make this child care choice because they prefer their children to stay in a home like environment. This arrangement may be less expensive than day care centers. Moreover, the children's groups are small so better care is given.

DO YOU KNOW?

The medium of education at preschool must be in mother tongue or in regional language of the child. Because, it helps the preschooler to learn the language that lays foundation for their future learning.